주류동향

SEWANG LIQUOR
WEEKLY JOURNAL

Japan deep dive Tabelog Hyakumeiten 2026

2026.11.18 · 3 min

Japan's 25 new yakitori entries: small and young



On the ground this issue · Japanese yakitori

Photo: Taniguchi official opening release

15 opened in 2024 or later and 18 have 10 seats or fewer — they sell drinks by name and glass

We opened up, one by one, the **25 shops listed for the first time** in Tabelog's 'Yakitori Hyakumeiten 2026' (top 100). A side-by-side with how Korean shops operate is in **07**; three things to bring to your shop are in **08**. What diners praised is in **03**.

SEATS	TIME	DRINKS
10 or fewer	2 seatings	Name · glass

THREE NUMBERS THIS ISSUE

10 Nov RELEASED

25	Yakitori shops on the Hyakumeiten list for the first time this year (East 12 · West 13)
15	Of those, opened in 2024 or later
13	Set a start time and seat guests all at once (two seatings, etc.)

Tabelog Hyakumeiten 2026 announcement (PR TIMES, 10 Nov) · each shop's Tabelog page (viewed 11 Nov)

Q KakaoTalk quiz — of the 25, how many put a **'priced drink pairing'** on the menu? Answer in **06**.

↓ Scroll down to read · no PDF needed · ☕ 2 MegaMGC Coffee drinks (08 · first 5 per issue, by Sat 21 Nov)

Reading prices · Won first, yen in brackets. Won figures are rounded reference values converted at the ECB reference rate of 13 Nov 2026 (¥100 ≈ KRW 836).

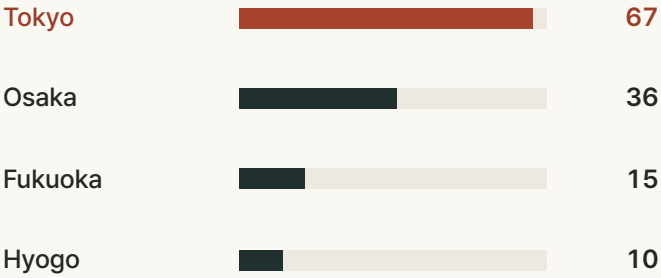
01

ANNOUNCED · 10 NOV

Japan's top 200 yakitori shops: 25 new this year

25 shops

'Hyakumeiten' is the list in which **Tabelog**, Japan's largest restaurant rating site, picks the top 100 shops by score in each genre. Yakitori gets 100 each for East and West Japan; this is the 8th edition. Of these, **25 are listed for the first time** (East 12 · West 13).



Kyoto 9

HOW TO READ

Bars show the number of shops by prefecture among the 200 (top 5). Ranked by Tabelog score as of 10 Sep. 'First time' means a shop never listed in any Hyakumeiten genre before; shops that moved or reopened are included.

WHY LOOK

Because the list is ranked by score, it shows **shops rated highly right now**. 15 of the 25 new entries opened in 2024 or later.

Source Tabelog Hyakumeiten 2026 announcement (PR TIMES, 10 Nov 2026) · award.tabelog.com Yakitori EAST/WEST 2026 (viewed 11 Nov)

02

NEW ENTRIES ⓘ YOUNG

15 of the 25 opened in 2024 or later

15 /25 shops

15 opened in 2024 or later. **4** made the list in the very year they opened (2026).

15	Opened **2024 or later**
11	Opened **2025 or later**
4	Opened **in 2026** — listed in their first year

Hikita ひき田 Ebisu, Tokyo · opened Jun 2026

Score 4.24 · top new entry, East Japan

8-seat counter. Dinner budget approx. KRW 167,000–251,000 (¥20,000–30,000). Cleared the selection cut-off date (10 Sep) about 3 months after opening.

Yakitori Taniguchi Tenjinbashi 焼鳥谷口 天神橋

Osaka · opened Jun 2026

Score 4.24 · top new entry, West Japan

A new 10-seater in Osaka from the owner of the renowned Hyogo shop「焼鳥 谷口」. The original Hyogo shop is run by his first apprentice. Two seatings, 17:30 · 20:30.

HOW TO READ

Opening dates from Tabelog shop info. The 5 shops with no opening date listed were not counted either way. Scores viewed 11 Nov.

> **IN COMMON**
>
> **9** of the 25 say in their shop intro or announcement that they come from a renowned shop or are a branch — **renowned skills + a small new shop**.

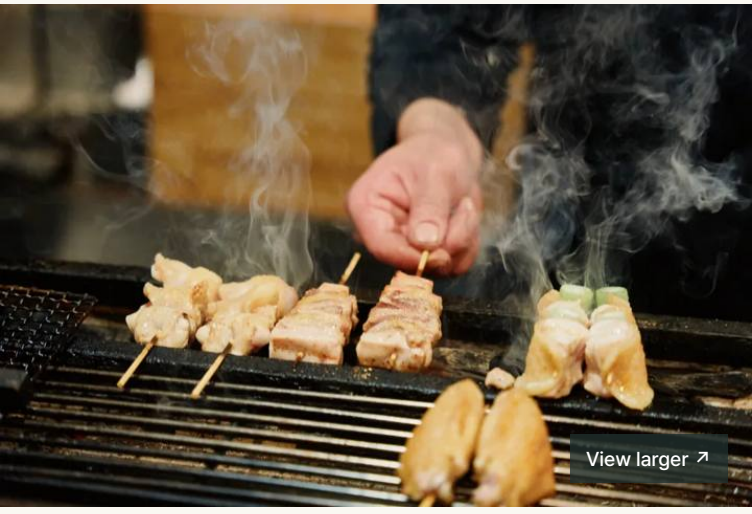
Source Tabelog shop pages (11 Nov) · PR TIMES 2 Jun 2026 (焼鳥谷口 天神橋 opening)

What diners wrote in reviews: first plate · timing · one glass

We read Tabelog reviews (Jun–Nov 2026) for the 5 most-reviewed shops and sorted what diners **repeatedly** praised into food · operations · drinks. Drawbacks are noted too.

01 / Yakitori Taniguchi Tenjinbashi 焼鳥谷口 天神橋

Osaka · score 4.24 · 145 reviews



The hands at work over the skewers

Cooking photo from the official opening press release.

Photo: 株式会社谷口一門 · PR TIMES opening release

Food It opens, from the first plate, with near-raw chicken such as **kombu-cured tenderloin**. The most common comment: Kyotamba Kosaka chicken grilled crisp outside, juicy inside.

Ops 10-seat counter, two seatings at 17:30 · 20:30. **No entry if more than 15**

minutes late — in return, every guest gets the course at the same pace.

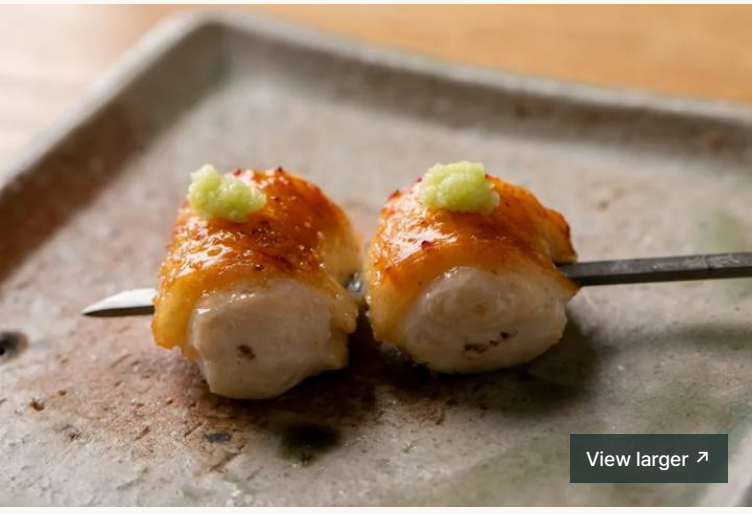
Drink

Reviews keep mentioning drinks recommended to match the food.

See photos on Tabelog →

02 / Sanzen 焼鳥 燦然

Osaka · score 3.92 · 140 reviews



Browned skin on metal skewers

Grilled chicken photo chosen from the official booking page.

Photo: 焼鳥 燦然 · TableCheck booking page

Food

Plates that show off freshness, like **white liver sashimi · breast sashimi**, come early in the course.

Ops

Titanium skewers, which conduct heat well, and bamboo skewers are used by ingredient; chicken is brushed with sesame and rice-bran oil, vegetables with chicken fat — diners copied the shop's explanation straight into their reviews. 8 seats, two seatings.

Drink — Even review titles say **'Kosaka chicken × wine pairing'**. The pairing is sold as a named course from the start — 7 wines approx. KRW 67,000 (¥8,000).

Cons — Some rate value for money as only average.

See photos on Tabelog →

03 / Yamanaka 焼鳥 山中

Hiroshima · score 3.73 · 27 reviews



A course at a small counter

Counter and back table shown on the booking page.

Photo: 一休.com 焼鳥 山中 booking page

Food — Aperitif → **breast · thigh tataki** → tsukune. Praise that the white liver is in a different league from other chicken.

Ops — One course, everyone starts together at 18:00 or 19:00. **'This much food at this price'** — generous portions for the price come up again and again.

Drink — **A glass of aperitif is included in the course**, plus a 3-drink set

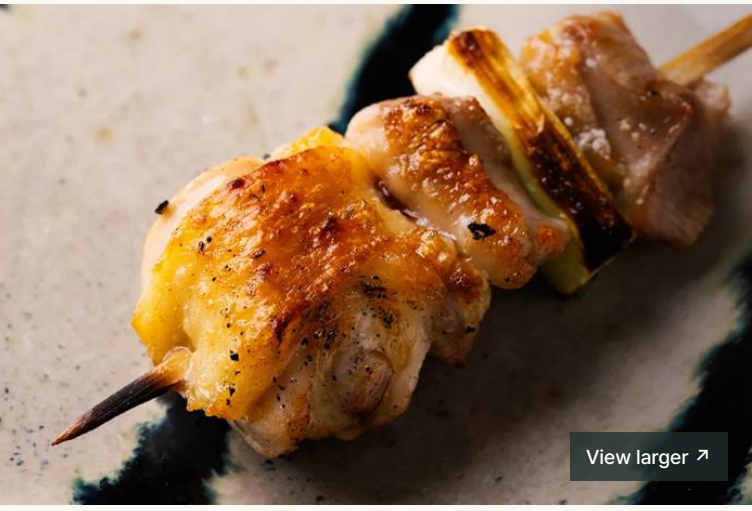
approx. KRW 25,000 (¥3,000) and even a non-alcoholic pairing tea.

Cons — Occasional complaints that smoke fills the room.

See photos on Tabelog →

04 / Torifumi 焼鳥 鳥ふみ

Saga · score 3.64 · 80 reviews



Aged Kuro-Satsuma chicken thigh skewers

A menu item the official website introduces by its cut.

Photo: 焼鳥 鳥ふみ official website

Food — **Aged** Kuro-Satsuma chicken breast and thigh, plus **rare cuts** served only that day (back liver, diaphragm, gizzard) — the reason to come back changes every time.

Ops — 13-seat hinoki counter. Many reviews say you won't get a seat without booking.

Drink — A regular: **'Here I always go for a Laphroaig highball'** — a highball is approx. KRW 7,400 (¥880). The reason: its

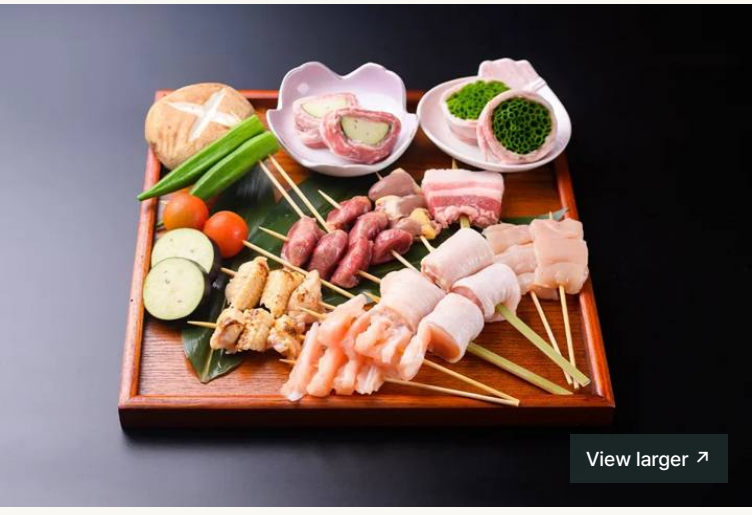
smoky aroma suits the skewers. Local sake comes in two sizes, glass or gō.

Cons — Occasional comments that drinks come out slowly.

See photos on Tabelog →

05 / Torikura とりくら Tenmonkan

Kagoshima · score 3.64 · 71 reviews



Chicken skewers, plus vegetable rolls

Official photo of skewers and vegetable rolls before grilling.

Photo: とりくら 天文館店 official website

Food — Kuro-Satsuma chicken skewers and vegetable rolls. Most reviews praise the grilling and the juiciness.

Ops — **Starts with a short course, bookable on the day, approx. KRW 21,000–29,000** (¥2,500–3,500), then carries on à la carte. Easy as a second stop.

Drink — Praise that **'it's a casual skewer shop, yet they use separate red and white**

wine glasses'. Satsuma shochu and nomihodai (all-you-can-drink) too.

Cons — Some complaints about sold-out items, slow service and the cover snack.

See photos on Tabelog →

HOW TO READ

Reviews are individual diners' opinions. We picked only points that overlapped across several reviews, and say so where a review repeats the shop's own explanation. Originals are in Japanese, condensed in translation. Photos are review candidates chosen from shops' official websites, booking pages and opening press releases; each is credited, with a link to Tabelog photos.

IN COMMON

Food: **a first plate that shows freshness**. Operations: **a time commitment**. Drinks: **a glass with a name**. The shop writes the 'one line' diners will put in their reviews before they do.

Source Tabelog review lists (each shop's dtlrvwlst, viewed 14 Nov 2026) · scores and review counts as of viewing

04

NEW ENTRIES ⊙ SMALL · ON THE CLOCK

18 with 10 seats or fewer, seating guests at set times

18/25 shops

18 have 10 seats or fewer, and **9** of those have exactly 8. Even the largest has 24.

18:00	2 hrs	20:00	15 min
Seating 1 starts together	One full course	Seating 2 starts together	Late = no entry (e.g.)

e.g. Torikaze 鳥かぜ 17:00 / 20:00 · Sanzen 燦然 weekdays 18:00 / 20:30 · Toriyoshi 鳥佳 (Ebisu) two seatings of 2.5 hrs

13	14	9
Set start time, all seated at once	Reservation only	Lateness / cancellation rules written

HOW TO READ

'Set start time' covers simultaneous starts, two seatings and fixed-time entry. 8 seats × 2 seatings = 16 guests a night. Even one empty seat hurts — likely why they write lateness and cancellation rules.

> SEOUL?
>
> MOZU in Cheongdam also says guests at its single table **start the dinner course together**. Korean examples are compared in 07.

Source Tabelog shop pages, booking and seating info (viewed 11 Nov)

05

NEW ENTRIES ⊘ HOW MUCH

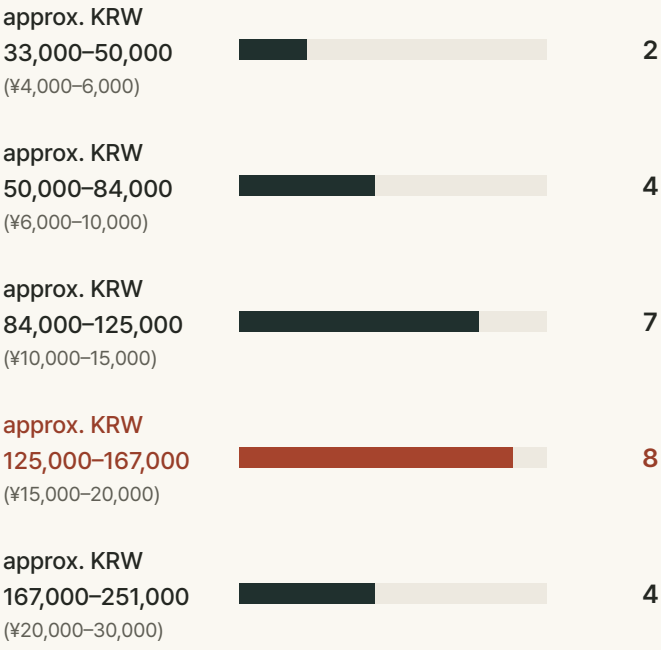
Dinner per person approx. KRW 80,000–170,000, courses are standard

Original budget band ¥10,000–20,000

approx. KRW 109,000

(¥13,000)

Median approx. KRW 109,000 (¥13,000) across the 16 shops that publish course prices; range approx. KRW 55,000–167,000 (¥6,600–20,000). 18 of the 25 centre on courses or omakase.



5	3	4
10% service charge	Seat charge / cover snack approx. KRW 2,500–10,000 (¥300–1,200)	À la carte shops at approx. KRW 33,000–67,000 (¥4,000–8,000)

Torikura とりくら Tenmonkan

Kagoshima · opened Jul 2025

Draft beer

approx. KRW 5,300 ·

(¥638)

Highball

approx. KRW 5,100

(¥605)

24 seats plus private rooms, open until 3 a.m. on Fri and Sat. Start with a short course, continue à la carte — the most affordable of the new entries.

HOW TO READ

Bars show the number of shops (of 25) by the dinner budget per person each shop lists on Tabelog. Reference won conversions come first, with the yen amount alongside. Whether drinks are included varies by shop. The approx. KRW 21,000–29,000 (¥2,500–3,500) short course (Torikura) is excluded from the course median.

READING

It's not only pricey courses — **4 à la carte shops at approx. KRW 33,000–67,000** (¥4,000–8,000) (all in West Japan) made the same list.

Source Tabelog shop and course pages (viewed 11 Nov)

06

NEW ENTRIES ⊙ HOW THEY SELL DRINKS

KakaoTalk quiz answer

Drinks are sold not by 'more' but by choice

Quiz — of the 25, how many put a 'priced drink pairing' on the menu?

① 2 ✓ | ② 9 | ③ 17

All 12 in East Japan mark wine as 'available', but a priced pairing exists at only **2** of all 25 (both in West Japan).

① One beer company, named on the menu

8 of 11

Master's Dream · The Premium Malt's · Sapporo Lager (a.k.a. Akaboshi)

Of the 11 shops where the beer brand could be confirmed, **8 carry beer from only one company** (2 confirmed only through Suntory's '神泡 (Kamiawa) certified' sign — shops whose pouring Suntory has certified).

MOZU also names **Suntory The Premium Malt's** on its beer menu — so guests can order by name.

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② Highballs named by whisky

All 5 that list highball prices

Base

approx. KRW 5,100–7,400

(¥605–880)

+ a premium tier

Named after the whisky, e.g. 'Kaku (角) highball approx. KRW 6,400 (¥770)'. 4 add a premium tier above it, such as Hakushu or Yamazaki, at approx. KRW 7,400–23,000 (¥880–2,700).

If your shop also lists the **whisky name and price**, guests can easily see the difference between the base highball and the premium tier.

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③ Drinks as a 'set'

Sanzen · Yamanaka

Pairing

approx. KRW 25,000–67,000

(¥3,000–8,000)

Sanzen 燦然 (Osaka): 7 wines approx. KRW 67,000 (¥8,000) · 4 wines approx. KRW 42,000 (¥5,000), with a sommelier. **Yamanaka 焼鳥 山中** (Hiroshima): 3-drink set approx. KRW 25,000 (¥3,000), plus a non-alcoholic pairing tea.

In Seoul, MOZU has **3-glass wine and 5-glass sake sets**, and Las Vegas has a **3-sake sampler**. Korean shops also bundle several glasses for guests to pick.

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④ Sake in two sizes

Torifumi · Saga

From approx. KRW 4,200 a glass

(¥500)

4 local sakes sold in two sizes, 'glass / gō (180 ml)'. Glass and gō prices approx. KRW 4,200–11,000 (¥500–1,260). Start small; go bigger if you like it.

HOW TO READ

Based on the 10 shops that posted drink menus on Tabelog, plus shop intros. The other 15 have no drink menu, so they were counted as 'not confirmed', not 'none'.

> THIS WEEK
>
> Thu 19 Nov: **Beaujolais Nouveau release** — a good week to add 'one glass' of wine to skewers.

Source Tabelog drink menus and shop info (viewed 11 Nov)

07 KOREAN SHOPS COMPARED · PUBLISHED MENUS

Three Seoul shops: how they sell courses and drinks

We set **MOZU, Yakitori Sho and Torino Las Vegas** alongside the Japanese examples, looking at **how the course starts, glass counts and prices, and ordering options**.

MOZU Cheongdam

Gangnam · a course that starts together, and drink sets

Dinner course KRW 125,000

Guests at the single table **start the dinner course together**. The drinks menu lists separate sets: **3 glasses of wine KRW 50,000 · 5 glasses of sake KRW 75,000**. Wine by the glass can also be chosen as sparkling, white or red.

Alongside Japan · Like Sanzen's wine line-up and Yamanaka's 3-drink set, it **tells guests the glass count and price up front**. MOZU's menu calls it 'Set Menu'.

1F, 12-4 Hakdong-ro 55-gil, Gangnam-gu, Seoul

MOZU menu · booking →

Yakitori Sho

Namyeong-dong · clear booking and ordering rules

Dinner price on booking page KRW 38,000

Takes bookings through RevitGuide and asks for **one alcoholic drink per person**. Extra special-cut skewers are capped at **2**. Beer, sake, wine and whisky are listed.

Alongside Japan · It **states the booking method and extra-order rules up front**, which a small shop running a course needs. A drink-order rule and a multi-glass set are worth looking at separately.

5-3 Hangang-daero 84-gil, Yongsan-gu, Seoul

Yakitori Sho shop · booking →

Torino Las Vegas

Euljiro · small tastings alongside all-you-can-drink

3-sake sampler KRW 12,000

The menu offers both a 'sake of the month 3-kind sampler' and **nomihodai for KRW 30,000**. Guests can choose between tasting a little of several drinks and drinking at a flat rate.

Alongside Japan · The point to compare with Yamanaka's 3-drink set: **getting guests to order several glasses as a bundle instead of a bottle**. All-you-can-drink and fixed-glass sets are treated separately.

1F, 13 Mareunnae-ro, Jung-gu, Seoul

Las Vegas shop · menu →

> FOR YOUR SHOP
>
> Make the course start time clear, and on the drinks menu show **brand · glass count · set price** together. Rather than 'how much guests drink', compare **how you let them choose**.

HOW TO READ

Examples confirmed from registered menus and booking info. Menu names and glass counts differ, so we did not rank by price alone. MOZU's is a course price and Yakitori Sho's is the dinner price shown on its booking page, so they are not a like-for-like price ranking. Drink sets, samplers and drink-order rules are listed separately.

Source MOZU registered menu and info on CatchTable (checked 14 Nov 2026; drinks menu updated 8 Jun 2026) · Yakitori Sho shop info on RevitGuide (checked 14 Nov 2026) · Torino Las Vegas registered menu on Tabling. Published menus may change; check when booking.

08

FOR YOUR SHOP · TO-DO

One line of times, one line of drink names, one 3-glass set

- [ ] **① Add 'Seating 1 18:00 · Seating 2 20:00' to December booking info**

  Start with the Fridays when year-end groups crowd in (4, 11, 18 Dec). Add a one-line lateness/cancellation rule too — 13 of Japan's new entries set start times, and 9 write lateness/cancellation rules

- [ ] **② Put names in the drinks section of your menu**

  'Draft beer' → the brand name; 'Highball' → the whisky name, like 'Kaku highball'. One base price + one premium tier is enough

- [ ] **③ Add a '3-glass set' option to skewer sets**

Work out the multi-glass bundle used by Yamanaka in Japan and MOZU and Las Vegas in Korea at your own prices — see the (example) below

3-glass set (example)

Per-person template

[5 skewers + 3-glass set · per person · KRW]

5-skewer set (example)	**18,000**
3 glasses ordered separately (highball 7,900 × 2 + glass of wine 9,000)	**24,800**
3-glass set price (example)	**18,000**
Guest saves	**approx. 7,000**

Cost of 3 glasses approx. 6,000 (highball approx. 2,000 × 2 + 1 glass of wine approx. 2,000)

= approx. KRW 12,000 left from the set's drinks

Highball cost per glass = 40 ml whisky approx. KRW 1,500 + soda, ice, lemon approx. KRW 400. Wine per glass = a KRW 10,000 wholesale bottle ÷ 5 glasses. Glass of wine KRW 9,000 and set KRW 18,000 are examples — plug in your own prices.

HOW TO READ

5 skewers + 3-glass set = approx. KRW 36,000 per person. The set pays off **when guests who used to stop at 1–2 glasses drink 3** — for guests who already ordered 3 separately, profit per glass falls. The margin is based on VAT-inclusive prices (approx. KRW 10,000 excluding VAT). Unlike all-you-can-drink, the glass count is fixed, so the cost is visible in advance.

ASK YOUR REP · THIS WEEK

1 A whisky to sell by name in highballs (on-trade Kakubin, etc.)

2 Wine to sell by the glass (wholesale under KRW 10,000 a bottle) · Beaujolais Nouveau

3 One Japanese beer to name on the menu (draft · bottle)

SHARE

Send it to owners in your area ☕

Look at a top Japanese skewer shop's drinks menu together with the shop next door, and you'll see your own. By Sat 21 Nov, the first 5 people for this issue can receive 2 MegaMGC Coffee Iced Americano vouchers, one drink per voucher. One claim per mobile number. Enter your number and consent to request your vouchers, then share the link.

Get 2 vouchers & share the link

By Sat 21 Nov · first 5 people for this issue · 2 Iced Americano vouchers, one drink each · one claim per number. Enter a number that can receive Korean text messages.

NEXT ISSUE · WED 25 NOV

Pre-December peak check

Planned (topic not yet final).

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